

Lecture 17:

Friday, 9th Sep. 2022

Let H be a subgroup of a group G .

$$\bullet \text{ For } a, b \in G, \quad aH = bH \Leftrightarrow a \sim_1 b \Leftrightarrow b^{-1}a \in H \Leftrightarrow a^{-1}b \in H$$
$$\text{In particular, } aH = H \Leftrightarrow a \in H.$$

$$\bullet \text{ For } a, b \in G, \quad Ha = Hb \Leftrightarrow a \sim_R b \Leftrightarrow ab^{-1} \in H \Leftrightarrow ba^{-1} \in H.$$
$$\text{In particular, } Ha = H \Leftrightarrow a \in H.$$

§ Normal subgroup: Let $H \leq G$. H is called a normal subgroup of G if $gH = Hg \quad \forall g \in G$.

Notation: We write $H \trianglelefteq G$ to mean that H is a normal subgroup of G .

- In a group G , $\{e\}$ and G are always normal subgroups of G .
- Every subgroup of an abelian group is normal.

• Let $H \leq G$. For $g \in G$, let

$$gHg^{-1} = \{ghg^{-1} : h \in H\}$$

- Easy to check that $gHg^{-1} \leq G \quad \forall g \in G$. (Prove this fact)

Theorem 1: Let H be a subgroup of G . Then, the following are equivalent:

- (1) $H \trianglelefteq G$ (2) $gHg^{-1} = H \quad \forall g \in G$ (3) $ghg^{-1} \in H \quad \forall g \in G, \forall h \in H$.

Proof: (1) $\Rightarrow$ (2): Let $H \trianglelefteq G$. Then, $gH = Hg \quad \forall g \in G$.

claim: $gHg^{-1} = H$

Let $x \in gHg^{-1}$. Then, $x = ghg^{-1}$ for some $h \in H$.

Since, $gH = Hg$, so $gh = h_1g$ for some $h_1 \in H$

$$\therefore x = ghg^{-1} = (h_1g)g^{-1} = h_1 \in H \Rightarrow gHg^{-1} \subseteq H. \rightarrow (1)$$

Again, if $h \in H$, then $hg \in Hg = gH$

$$\Rightarrow hg = gh_2 \text{ for some } h_2 \in H \Rightarrow h = gh_2g^{-1} \in gHg^{-1}$$

$$\therefore H \subseteq gHg^{-1} \rightarrow (2) \quad \text{From (1) \& (2), we have } gHg^{-1} = H$$

if $H \trianglelefteq G$.

$$(2) \Rightarrow (3): \quad gHg^{-1} = H \quad \forall g \in G$$

$$\Rightarrow ghg^{-1} \in H \quad \forall g \in G \text{ and } \forall h \in H.$$

③ $\Rightarrow$ (1): Let $ghg^{-1} \in H \quad \forall g \in G$ and $\forall h \in H$.

Claim: $H \trianglelefteq G$, that is, $gH = Hg \quad \forall g \in G$.

Let $g \in G$ and $x \in gH$. Then, $x = gh$ for some

Since $ghg^{-1} \in H$, so $ghg^{-1} = h_1$ for some $h_1 \in H$. $h \in G$.

$$\Rightarrow gh = h_1g \Rightarrow x = gh = h_1g \in Hg$$

$\therefore gH \subseteq Hg$. Similarly, we can prove that $Hg \subseteq gH$.

This completes the proof. #

Thm 2: Let $H \leq G$ be such that $[G:H] = 2$.

Then, $H \trianglelefteq G$.

Proof: Let $g \in G$.

Case I: $g \in H$. Then, $gH = H = Hg$.

Case II: $g \notin H$. Then, $H \neq gH$ and $H \neq Hg$.

Since $[G:H] = 2$, so $G = H \cup gH$ and $G = H \cup Hg$
 $\Rightarrow gH = Hg$.

Hence $gH = Hg \ \forall g \in G \Rightarrow H \trianglelefteq G$. #

Ex: $SL_2(\mathbb{R})$ is a normal subgroup of $GL_2(\mathbb{R})$.

Solution: For $A \in GL_2(\mathbb{R})$ and $B \in SL_2(\mathbb{R})$,

$$\det(ABA^{-1}) = 1. \quad \text{Hence, } ABA^{-1} \in SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \quad \forall A \in GL_2(\mathbb{R})$$
$$\therefore SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \trianglelefteq GL_2(\mathbb{R}). \quad \forall B \in SL_2(\mathbb{R}).$$

Quotient groups: Let $H \trianglelefteq G$. Let G/H denote the set of all the left cosets of H in G (or set of all the right cosets of H in G), that is, $G/H = \{gH \mid g \in G\} = \{Hg \mid g \in G\}$. Then, the operation $aH \cdot bH = abH$ is well-defined.

Proof: Let $aH = cH$ and $bH = dH$.

Claim: $abH = cdH$.

Let $x \in abH$. Then, $x = abh$
 $= c \underline{h_1} d h_2 h$

Since $H \trianglelefteq G$, so $h_1, d = d h_3$ for some

$\therefore x = abh = c \underline{h_1} d h_2 h = cd h_3 h_2 h$
 $\in cdH$

$\in cdH$

$\therefore abH \subseteq cdH$.

Similarly, we can prove that $cdH \subseteq abH$. #

$\therefore abH = cdH$.

$a \in aH$

$\Rightarrow a = ch_1$

$b \in bH$

$\Rightarrow b = dh_2$

for some

$h_1, h_2 \in H$

Theorem 3: Let $H \trianglelefteq G$. Then $G/H = \{gH \mid g \in G\}$ is a group under the operation $aH \cdot bH = abH$, $a, b \in G$.

Proof: (i) We have prove that the binary map

$$G/H \times G/H \longrightarrow G/H$$

$$(aH, bH) \longmapsto abH \text{ is well-defined.}$$

(ii) H is the identity

$$(iii) (aH)^{-1} = a^{-1}H$$

$$(iv) (aH \cdot bH) \cdot cH = abH \cdot cH$$

$$= (abc)H = (a(bc))H$$

$\therefore G/H$ is a group.

$$= aH \cdot (bH \cdot cH).$$

Definition: Let $H \trianglelefteq G$. Then, the group G/H is called the quotient group of H in G .

Ex: $GL_2(\mathbb{R}) / SL_2(\mathbb{R}) = \{ A \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \mid A \in GL_2(\mathbb{R}) \}.$

$$= \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} x & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \mid x \in \mathbb{R}, x \neq 0 \right\}.$$

$$\bullet \begin{pmatrix} x_1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) = \begin{pmatrix} x_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \Leftrightarrow x_1 = x_2$$

Proof: $\begin{pmatrix} x_1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) = \begin{pmatrix} x_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot SL_2(\mathbb{R}) \Leftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} x_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}^{-1} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in SL_2(\mathbb{R})$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{x_1}{x_2} = 1 \Leftrightarrow x_1 = x_2$$

- For $A, B \in \text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, $A \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) = B \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$
 $\Leftrightarrow |A| = |B|$

Proof: $|A| = |B| \Rightarrow |A^{-1}B| = 1$

$$\Rightarrow A^{-1}B \in \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \Rightarrow A \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) = B \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$$

Conversely, $A \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) = B \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$

$$\Rightarrow A^{-1}B \in \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \Rightarrow |A^{-1}B| = 1 \Rightarrow |A| = |B|.$$

$$\therefore A \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) = B \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \Leftrightarrow \det(A) = \det(B).$$

In particular, if $\det(A) = x$, $x \neq 0$, then
 $A \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) = \begin{pmatrix} x & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}).$ $\neq$